

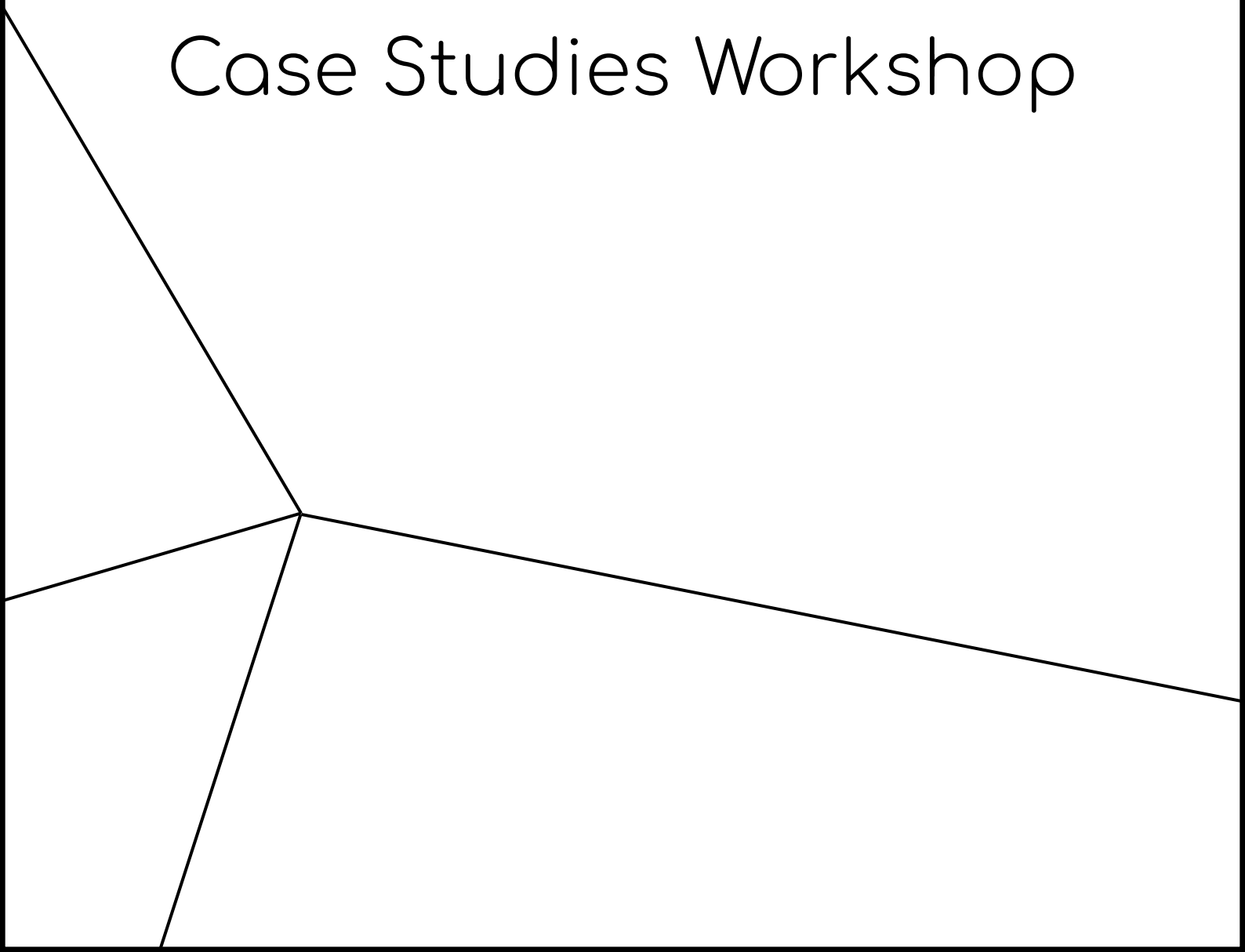


UNIVERSITY OF
BIRMINGHAM
DUBAI

برنامج الذكاء الاصطناعي
THE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE PROGRAM

AI or Not?

Case Studies Workshop





Case 1: Auto-Fill Web Forms

Background:

AlSahra Real Estate is a mid-sized property management firm based in Dubai, UAE. AlSahra Real Estate manages **over 3,000 residential and commercial units** across Dubai, Sharjah, and Ajman. The department we will be working with is Customer Relations & Leasing, and relevant Stakeholders are: Leasing agents, admin staff, prospective tenants, IT department



The Challenge:

AlSahra Real Estate receives **hundreds** of online tenant applications and lease renewal forms per month. Despite having an internal CRM (customer relationship management) system housing up-to-date tenant data (name, Emirates ID, tenancy start/end dates, unit details, etc.), staff still **manually re-enter this information into web forms** for government portals, maintenance service platforms, and utility provider sites.

This manual entry:

- Leads to frequent **errors** (e.g., incorrect Emirates ID or unit number)
- Causes **delays**, especially during peak seasons
- **Frustrates** staff and tenants alike
- Increases **compliance risks** due to erroneous submissions

Should we use AI?

Guiding Questions:

1. If AlSahra scaled to handle 10x the tenants, would the same solution (whether AI or not) still work? Why or why not?
2. What are the risks of using AI? What are the risks of using non-AI?
3. What does the success of your solution depend on?
4. Are there any assumptions you are making about the data or how it is organized?
5. Can you estimate how long your solution would take to implement (entire life cycle)?
6. What steps would you take to build your idea?
7. Are there any privacy or security constraints with your solution?



Case 2: Customer Concierge Chatbot

Background:

NuraMall is a smart, mid-sized shopping mall located in Abu Dhabi's Reem Island, housing over 150 retail outlets, including international brands, restaurants, local boutiques, and service kiosks. With a strategic goal to position itself as a tech-enabled lifestyle destination, NuraMall has invested in digital innovations like a mobile app, QR-based parking, and augmented reality wayfinding.

Their customer service desk—located at the main entrance—was traditionally staffed with 2–3 agents handling:

- Store location inquiries
- Lost and found
- Ongoing promotions
- Parking issues
- Mall events and kids' activities



The Challenge:

With visitor footfall increasing by 40% year-over-year, the in-person help desk was overwhelmed—especially during weekends, public holidays, and events like the Abu Dhabi Shopping Festival.

Key Issues:

- Long wait times (5–10 minutes during peak hours)
- Staff burnout
- Inconsistent information shared by different agents
- Language limitations: Most agents spoke English and Arabic, but customers frequently asked questions in Hindi, Urdu, Tagalog, and Russian

Should we use AI?

Guiding Questions:

1. Where should this system be deployed (just the customer service desk)?
2. What features can this chatbot have without AI? What features would need AI?
3. Do you need AI to handle multilingual user queries?
4. Any ethical or privacy concerns with chatbot deployment in public spaces?
5. Is your system easy to update and keep current if information changes?
6. What are the risks of using an AI solution? What are the risks of using a non-AI solution?



Case 3: Detecting Broken Links on a Website

Background:

UrbanNova, headquartered in Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM), is a leading smart city solutions provider in the UAE. The company develops and manages digital platforms for urban mobility, environmental monitoring, public signage, and analytics dashboards, used by **municipalities** and **government clients** across the country.

Their flagship platform, **LiveSmart UAE**, powers:

- **Real-time** traffic and public transport dashboards
- **Interactive maps** for scooters, park occupancy, and air quality
- Public services **accessed via QR codes** on kiosks, signage, and buses
- **Links** to citizen forms, data downloads, and APIs



With millions of users and high government visibility, uptime and digital integrity are critical.

The Challenge:

In early 2025, UrbanNova launched a major upgrade to LiveSmart UAE **to support Expo-related traffic and showcase its expanded smart mobility features**. But within days, complaints began flooding in:

- Government clients **couldn't open linked project reports**
- Environmental partners reported **404 errors on data downloads**
- QR codes on public signage led to **broken or outdated URLs**
- External links to municipal data portals **expired or were deprecated**
- QR code campaigns were **not updated** when page URLs changed
- Editors published new content but **reused broken links** from older templates
- **No automated system** existed to test or validate links across platforms

Should we use AI?

Guiding Questions:

1. What pattern do you recognize when deciding if a link is faulty or not?
2. What steps would you take to set up your solution?
3. How might the scale or public visibility of the platform influence your choice between AI and automation?



Case 4: Predicting Churn

Background:

Cartvana is a popular UAE-based online marketplace offering grocery delivery, personal care products, and household items through a sleek mobile app. It **operates a monthly subscription model** (AED 29/month) for premium users, which includes:

- Unlimited free delivery
- Access to flash deals
- Priority support and early access to new product lines



With over 400,000 users across Dubai, Abu Dhabi, and Sharjah, Cartvana depends heavily on **retaining its high-frequency shoppers**.

The Challenge:

In early 2025, Cartvana noticed a troubling trend:

- **Churn among subscribers** spiked from 9% to nearly 16% monthly
- Marketing campaigns were **underperforming**
- Customer support saw a rise in **quiet cancellations with no feedback**

Management needed a reliable way to **predict which users were likely to churn before they did**, so they could intervene with targeted actions.

Should we use AI?

Guiding Questions:

1. What features would you look at when deciding or predicting whether subscribers are likely to churn?
2. What are the challenges of labeling churn — when exactly does someone count as “gone”?
3. How might false positives (you predict the customer will churn but the customer does not churn) and false negatives (you predict the customer will not churn but the customer actually churns) affect marketing costs and customer trust?
4. What ethical concerns might arise if this system starts flagging and targeting users aggressively?
5. What steps would you take to build your idea?
6. Are there any privacy or security constraints with your solution?